

Sweet Leaf -- Black Sabbath

From *Master of Reality* (1971). About 94 BPM for the main riff, est.

Bass: Harley Benton P/J, 5-string, passive. GP-5 only.

Tuning: as far as I know the record is down a step and a half, in C#. On the 5-string you can stay in standard and play the riff off the low B, reading everything down a step and a half. Or detune to match the guitarist.

Geezer Butler's part doubles and thickens the riff. It's fat, fuzzy, and loud, part of the wall rather than underneath it.

I haven't verified the exact bass rig on the record.

Fingers, dug in hard. Both pickups up, P forward. Tone knob around 60%.

AMP: Classic Bass (Ampeg SVT) + CAB: Sunn215 IR (User IR 8)

A driven SVT into Sunn215. The IR notes call the Sunn 2x15 fat, one-of-a-kind, and great with distortion. That's doom bass in a sentence.

Module chain

NR -- Gate, always on.

THRE: 25.

The gain is up. 25 keeps the riff stops tight.

PRE -- Micro Boost (MXR M133), on CTL.

Gain: 40.

On CTL. Pushes the whole drive chain harder, with more level and fuzz, for the up-tempo middle jam.

DST -- Bass OD, always on.

Gain: 55, Blend: 50, VOL: 55, Bass: 58, Treble: 48.

Always on, and a core part of the tone. Gain 55 at Blend 50 is a fuzzy growl that still keeps the fundamental solid.

AMP -- Classic Bass, always on.

Gain: 48, Bass: 60, Middle: 58, MidFreq: 450Hz, Treble: 45, VOL: 62.

SVT hair at gain 48. The 450Hz mids give the woolly body that doubles the guitar.

CAB -- User IR 8 (Sunn215), always on.

VOL: 60.

EQ -- Bass EQ 2, always on.

50Hz: +1, 120Hz: +2, 400Hz: +2, 800Hz: +1, 4.5kHz: -3, VOL: 52.

+2 at 400Hz for wool and grind. The top is trimmed so the fuzz doesn't sizzle.

MOD -- off.

DLY -- off.

RVB -- off. Dry. The wall is loud enough.

CTL footswitch

On CTL: PRE (Micro Boost).

- **CTL off** -- Main riff and verses. A fat, fuzzy riff-double. This is the resting state the patch loads into.
- **CTL on** -- Middle jam. Micro Boost drives everything harder for the faster section.

Engage when the band kicks into the jam. Drop back for the return of the main riff.